MARLI GUIMARÃES FERNANDES

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marli.fernandes@unipd.it ◇ Linkedin ◇ Website ◇ Orcid

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary fields: Applied microeconomics, Political economy
Research methods: Causal inference, Natural language processing

ACADEMIC POSITION

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellow 09/2025-08/2027
Università Degli Studi di Padova, Department of Economics and Management "Marco Fanno"
Research grant funded by the European Union's Horizon Europe program
Visiting fellow at Harvard Business School (host Prof. Vincent Pons) Fall 2026

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics 2017 - 2024
Nova School of Business and Economics
Approved with Distinction and Honors
Visiting PhD student at Sciences Po 02/2022 - 04/2022

Master in Economics 2014 - 2016
Major in Public Policy
Nova School of Business and Economics

Undergraduate degree in Economics 2011 - 2014
Nova School of Business and Economics
Exchange Program at Aarhus School of Business and Social Sciences Fall 2013

AFFILIATIONS

Economics for Policy Knowledge Center (Nova SBE) 2022 - Present

RESEARCH - WORKING PAPERS

When Women Run Against Men: Evidence from Political Platforms

Do female and male candidates campaign differently, and why? Using individual political platforms from French legislative elections between 1981 and 2024, I combine a transformer machine learning model with a regression discontinuity design that exploits the two-round structure of French elections to identify the causal impact of candidate gender on campaign content. Female and male candidates who barely qualify discuss the same issues in the first-round, but women write 6 percentage points less of their platform in a communal register. Between the two rounds, the gender gap in male-stereotyped topics rises by 4.7 percentage points, driven by male candidates, who withdraw from these topics and reallocate space to framing the national contest. This effect appears only when male politicians compete against another man, as they try to differentiate themselves from their opponents. Women increase their use of communal language, closing the gender gap, but do not adapt their behavior to their opponent's gender.

RESEARCH - WORK IN PROGRESS

Populism Contagion: Strategic Policy Responses to Populist Opponents
(draft available upon request)
Do mainstream politicians adopt the far-right's agenda when they face it at the ballot box? Focusing on French legislative elections (1988-2024), I implement a regression discontinuity design and compare leading mainstream candidates whose far-right opponent barely qualified for the runoff with those whose opponent barely missed the threshold. I first document that facing a far-right opponent raises the mainstream candidate's probability of election by roughly 25 percentage points - evidence of a front républicain in which voters consolidate behind the leading mainstream candidate. Given this selection effect, I bound behavioral responses using the regression discontinuity design with sample selection of Dong (2019). Adjustment occurs in office rather than on the campaign trail: candidates do not change their campaign agendas, but once in parliament, elected candidates who faced the far-right devote 8 to 10 percentage points more of their debate speech to far-right topics in the raw comparison.

How to Win an Election Against a Populist
Stage: data preparation completed. Estimating median voter preferences at the precinct level.

PUBLICATIONS

Ne me quitte pas! School closures and electoral outcomes in France (with José Tavares), *Journal of Economic Geography*, 2026, lbag030.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Bando Visiting Abroad (DSEA_ALTRO_BIRD26_02) (€ 5500)	2026
dSEA Mini Grant 2026 (€ 2000)	2026
dSEA Mini Grant 2026 (€ 2000)	2026
Marie Sklodowska-Curie postdoctoral fellowship (€ 193,643.28)	2025
Project #POPULISMCONTAGION funded by the European Union's Horizon Europe program HORIZON-MSCA-2024-PF-01-01. Grant agreement no. 101205531	
dSEA Mini Grant 2024 (€ 2000)	2024
Fundação para a Ciência e Tecnologia (FCT) Graduate Scholarship	2017-2022
Socrates/Erasmus scholarship (EU)	2013

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

2026 Workshop "The Political Economy of Reforms and the Costs of Populism", COMPTEXT, Lisbon Micro Group, University of Padova, EPSA, APSA
2025 18th Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal
2024 ENS Lyon, Verona Early Career Workshop in Economics, NICEP Conference 2024, 3rd Junior Economists Meeting UniMi - JEM24, BoMoPaV Economics Meeting 2024, "Text-as-Data in Economics" Workshop at the University of Liverpool Management School, 8th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop, 7th University of Bolzano Workshop on Political Economy, 18th CESifo Workshop on Political Economy
2023 22nd Journées Louis-André Gérard-Varet, 16th Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal, European Public Choice Society, Lisbon Micro Group, Nova SBE Applied Micro Lunch
2021 36th Annual Conference of the Italian Association of Labour Economists, 14th Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal, 14th Spanish Labour Economics Meeting, SOEP Brown Bag Seminar

POLICY RESEARCH

The effects of non-cognitive skills on the native-migrant labor market gap, *Migration Studies*, Volume 14, Issue 2, 2026.

European Union Continental AI Action Plan: Analysis of the Portuguese Labor Market. 2026
Youth income tax. 2025
European Union Pact on migration and asylum. 2024
Restoring teachers' total service time. 2024
More housing.. 2024
Non-adjustment of the pensions according to law 53-B/2006. 2023
Sustainable employment commitment. 2023
(with Marlon Francisco and Francesco Franco). *Nova SBE Economics for Policy Knowledge Center*

Social mobility in Portugal (with Teresa Bago d'Uva). *Fundação Francisco Manuel dos Santos.* 2017

The empirics of agglomeration economies: the link with productivity. (with Sílvia Santos and Ana Gouveia). *GEE Papers n. 67.* 2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Workshop Natural Language Processing for Social Sciences Summer 2027
Università Degli Studi di Padova

Invited Teaching Assistant - Grader 2018-2020, Spring 2023-2024
Nova School of Business and Economics
Economics of Poverty, Public Finance, Seminar on Current Economic and Financial Issues, Politics for Policy (MSc), Empirical Methods for Finance (MSc); Macroeconomics, Global Business Environment (BSc)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral researcher 02/2024-07/2025
Università Degli Studi di Padova

Research Assistant 2022-2025
Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Franco
Evaluation of public policies in an intergenerational perspective

Research Assistant 2016-2017
Supervisor: Prof. Teresa Bago d'Uva (Erasmus University Rotterdam)
Project "Social Mobility in Portugal".

Economic analyst for Portugal Economy Probe 2015

COMPLEMENTARY EDUCATION

Economic Analysis of Text and other Non-Standard Data 2026
ISEG

15th Lisbon Machine Learning Summer School 2025
Instituto Superior Técnico

1st Machine Learning Porto Summer School 2021
Católica Porto Business School

Big Data (with R) 2019
Instituto de Ciências Sociais, Universidade de Lisboa

REFEREE SERVICE

Economic Modelling, Migration Studies, Journal of Institutional Economics

OTHER INFORMATION

Software	Stata, Python, R, Latex, MS Office
Language	Portuguese (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Italian (basic)
Nationality	Portuguese

REFERENCES

Prof. Antonio Nicolò
Full Professor of Economics
Università Degli Studi di Padova
antonio.nicolo@unipd.it
Website

Prof. Edoardo Grillo
Full Professor of Economics
Università Degli Studi di Padova
edoardo.grillo@unipd.it
Website

Prof. José Tavares (PhD Advisor)
Full Professor of Economics
Nova School of Business and Economics
jtavares@novasbe.pt
Website